



INDEPENDENT FUNERAL-COST TRANSPARENCY

FuneralCostInfo.com buildout plan

A complete product, data, technical, monetization, launch, and validation plan for a low-maintenance U.S. cost-transparency property.

DECISION DOCUMENT

PHASE 0 READY

\$0 INFRASTRUCTURE

POSITIONING

What funerals really cost, from a site that takes no money from funeral homes.

PREPARED

23 September 2026

RECOMMENDATION

Conditional go

Build the data asset first; earn the right to scale

FuneralCostInfo is a credible low-operations bet because public data supports a useful estimator, demand is evergreen, and monetization can occur on a visitor's first session. The cost is patience: this project needs a deliberate 120-day search validation window, not a 14-day test.

\$8,300

NFDA 2023 MEDIAN

Viewing and burial, excluding vault, cemetery, marker, and cash advances.[1]

\$6,280

NFDA 2023 MEDIAN

Viewing and cremation, with the defined NFDA bundle.[1]

\$12/yr

REQUIRED CASH

Approximate domain cost; static hosting and public data can start at \$0.

Why it can win

- **Open position:** no dominant, consumer-only funeral-cost data brand combines methodology, state estimates, and an interactive calculator.
- **Engineered economics:** ads provide a floor; disclosed final-expense leads can provide materially higher yield.
- **Autonomy fit:** static pages, versioned data, and an annual refresh avoid a database, account system, or support queue.
- **Owner fit:** a senior engineer can build the defensible component - model, calculator, and publishing pipeline - rather than compete on article volume.

What must be true

- Google and AI engines index and cite the original data experience.
- Modeled estimates are labeled so clearly that criticism strengthens, rather than erodes, trust.
- Monetization remains restrained around bereaved families.
- The owner accepts a slower evidence loop than the normal 7-14 day rule.

Recommendation: approve a five-state Phase 0 only. Do not build all 50 states, buy links, or create a directory until Search Console shows real demand.

Phase 0 outcome

One production-quality home page, five state pages, the calculator, methodology, statistics, trust pages, and launch instrumentation. Owner involvement is capped at five hours for decisions, domain purchase, account approvals, and final review.

The opening is independence plus reproducible numbers

Demand is pain-driven and renews with each family; repeat visits are not required. Searchers arrive with immediate price questions, and every new visitor can generate an ad impression or a voluntary referral. The gap is not “more funeral content.” It is a transparent estimate system with no funeral-home paymaster.

Competitor type	Strength	Business-model constraint	Opening for FuneralCostInfo
Parting / Parting Pro	15,000+ provider directory; price data	Also sells operations software to funeral homes.[5]	Stay consumer-side; avoid provider software
Funeralocity	Provider comparison and rebates	Program members pay per resulting referred family.[6]	No funeral-home referral payments
Cake / Everplans	Large planning libraries and tools	Acquired in 2024 by funeral-industry players.[7][8]	Own cost transparency narrowly
Insurance affiliates	Commercial-intent landing pages	Quote-first content weakens neutrality	Lead with sources and methodology
Broad data publishers	Domain authority and state tables	Generic pages; limited funeral-specific method	Calculator, inclusions, uncertainty, updates

Confirmed economic signals

- Final-expense keyword research: roughly \$8-\$20 CPC for commercial terms.
- Observed affiliate structures: \$20-\$60 per lead or \$100-\$300 per sale.
- Lead buyers reportedly pay about \$20-\$45 for fresh final-expense leads.
- Informational long-tail traffic often carries lower CPC, so affiliate intent matching matters.

Positioning rules

- “Modeled estimate” appears beside every state number.
- Never imply a provider quote or guaranteed local price.
- Never rank funeral homes for payment.
- Keep quote modules secondary to the answer.
- Publish conflicts, affiliate relationships, and update dates.

Strategic tension: insurance commissions can fund the site, but an aggressive quote funnel would erase the independence claim. Treat trust as the primary conversion asset.

The site answers one question at three levels

FAST ANSWER

State estimate

A concise, source-dated range with inclusions.

PERSONAL ANSWER

Calculator

State, service type, and optional items.

DEFENSIBLE ANSWER

Methodology

Formula, caveats, calibration, and versions.

Launch inventory and purpose

Section	What ships	Primary user job	Conversion
Home	Calculator hero, state index, trust proof	Orient and estimate	Start calculator
State pages	50 at maturity; 5 in Phase 0	Understand local cost	Print / optional quote
Calculator	Six service types, optional items	Build a realistic budget	Print / compare quotes
Methodology	Sources, formula, limits, versions	Verify the estimate	Cite / link
Statistics	Quotable national and state facts	Research and reporting	Cite / download
Guides	8 core decision guides	Act with less confusion	Calculator / official source
Trust pages	About, editorial, disclosure, contact, privacy	Assess independence	Trust

Every state page lists

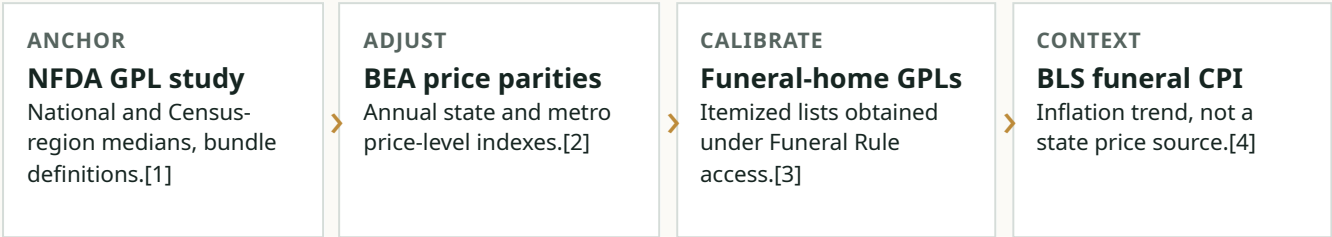
- Traditional burial with viewing
- Burial plus vault
- Cremation with viewing/service
- Direct cremation
- Immediate/direct burial
- Green burial estimate
- Included and excluded line items
- State notes, official links, and FAQs

Core guides

- FTC Funeral Rule rights
- Burial vs. cremation costs
- Direct cremation
- Green burial
- Veterans burial benefits
- Who pays / no money for a funeral
- Prepaid plans: benefits and risks
- Funeral-price glossary

Scope guardrail: do not launch provider reviews, obituaries, memorial commerce, or user accounts. Each creates moderation, support, or independence problems without validating the core thesis.

Public inputs support an honest model, not a local quote



Launch formula

```
stateEstimate = nationalMedian
  × (stateRPP / 100)

Example only:
$8,300 × (110.7 / 100)
= $9,188 modeled estimate
```

California's 2024 all-items RPP was 110.7; Mississippi's was 87.0. BEA expresses the national price level as 100.[2] The example shows mechanics, not a provider quote.

Versioned source files

```
/data/nfda-2023.json
/data/bea-rpp-2024.json
/data/bls-funeral-cpi.json
/data/service-definitions.json
/data/model-v1.json
/data/sources.json
```

Every output stores source year, model version, generated date, and inclusion set.

Methodology promises

Promise	Implementation	Reason
Label estimates	"Modeled state estimate," never "average local price"	Avoid false precision
Name exclusions	Cemetery, monument, flowers, clergy, obituary, cash advances	NFDA bundles omit major extras
Publish uncertainty	Range plus confidence tier; no single-number pretense	In-state variation is large
Show provenance	Source, year, formula, update log on every result	Trust and citation
Calibrate	Sample GPLs; report N and geographic coverage	Test model against observed menus

Legal precision: the Funeral Rule requires accurate price information by phone and a written General Price List when in-person discussions begin; it does not universally require a funeral home to email a GPL. Sampling workflows must ask, not misstate the law.[3]

The calculator exposes choices, assumptions, and exclusions

Inputs

- 1 **Location:** state at launch; metro after validated demand.
- 2 **Service type:** burial, burial with vault, cremation service, direct cremation, immediate burial, green burial.
- 3 **Optional items:** embalming, viewing, ceremony, hearse, printed package, casket/urn tier.
- 4 **Known local prices:** optional user overrides for cemetery or merchandise.

Outputs

- Low / modeled center / high range
- Printable line-item receipt
- Included and excluded items
- Source dates and model version
- Questions to ask a funeral home
- Optional, disclosed insurance quote link

Result logic

- 1. Load service bundle
- 2. Apply state RPP factor
- 3. Add selected options
- 4. Add user-entered local costs
- 5. Apply published uncertainty band
- 6. Render result + provenance
- 7. Track anonymous event only

No personal profile: calculations stay client-side. Do not collect a decedent's name, health information, beneficiary details, or exact address.

Reusable state-page template

Order	Module	Acceptance criterion
1	Direct answer	40-60 words; source + year + “modeled”
2	Cost table	Six services; inclusions visible
3	Calculator	State preselected; no JS-only key facts
4	How estimated	Formula summary + methodology link
5	Cost drivers	Specific to service mix and RPP
6	Rights and savings	FTC facts + official state links
7	FAQs	Real questions; matching FAQ schema
8	Disclosure / update	Affiliate status, reviewed date, sources

Editorial rule: generated prose is never the product. Each page must add the model output, service definitions, state-specific official resources, and a human-readable explanation of limits.

Pre-render every answer and make discovery deterministic

Application

- Next.js static export
- React calculator, client-side only
- MDX guides + JSON datasets
- No database, login, or server runtime
- Cloudflare Pages free tier

Performance budget

- LCP ≤ 2.5 seconds at p75
- INP ≤ 200 ms at p75
- CLS ≤ 0.10 at p75
- Initial JS ≤ 120 KB compressed
- No third-party script before consent

Canonical URL blueprint

/	Home
/funeral-costs/	State hub
/funeral-costs/california/	State page
/calculator/	Estimator
/methodology/	Model and changelog
/statistics/	Quotable data
/guides/ftc-funeral-rule/	Guide
/about/ /editorial-policy/ /privacy/ /affiliate-disclosure/	

Sitemap index

- **/sitemap.xml** → index
- **/sitemaps/core.xml** → home, trust, method
- **/sitemaps/states.xml** → hub + states
- **/sitemaps/guides.xml** → guides
- **/sitemaps/tools.xml** → calculator + statistics

Include only canonical, indexable, 200-status URLs. Store accurate last-modified dates.

Internal linking hierarchy

- Home → state hub → every state
- State page → calculator + 2-3 relevant guides
- Guide → calculator + applicable state hub
- Statistics → methodology + every source series
- BreadcrumbList schema mirrors visible breadcrumbs

Avoid paginated archives; the catalog is finite and static. Hreflang is unnecessary for a U.S.-only English launch.

robots.txt policy

```
User-agent: *
Allow: /
Disallow: /api/
Disallow: /_next/static/chunks/*.map$
Sitemap: [final canonical origin]/sitemap.xml
```

Do not block canonical HTML, CSS, JavaScript, images, or the calculator. Add explicit AI-bot groups only to document a permissive decision; rules must match the final domain after purchase.

Write facts so humans can verify them and models can quote them

Simple “average cost” answers may be consumed inside AI Overviews. The counterplay is not hiding data; it is becoming the named source for complex, reproducible answers that assistants cite.

Answer-first page contract

- First 40-60 words answer the exact query.
- Use semantic **h1**, **h2**, tables, lists, and visible citations.
- Repeat statistics consistently: “NFDA 2023 median: \$8,300 for viewing and burial.”
- Put key facts in pre-rendered HTML, never only after JavaScript runs.
- Use FAQPage schema only when the same Q&A is visible.
- Evaluate Speakable schema for concise answer blocks; never mark entire pages.

Machine-readable surfaces

- **/llms.txt** - concise site purpose, methodology, canonical data pages, citation guidance.
- **/statistics/** - national facts, state table, definitions, source dates, downloadable CSV.
- **/methodology/** - formula, assumptions, validation sample, version history.
- **JSON-LD** - Organization, WebSite, BreadcrumbList, Article, FAQPage where eligible.
- **Stable anchors** - one URL and fragment per defined statistic or method step.

Deliberate crawler access

Bot	Launch decision	Reason
GPTBot	Allow	Potential assistant discovery and citation
ClaudeBot	Allow	Potential assistant discovery and citation
PerplexityBot	Allow	Potential answer-engine citation
Google-Extended	Allow	Deliberate participation in Google AI uses

Crawler names and controls change. Verify current documentation before launch and record the decision in the editorial policy. Permissive crawling does not guarantee citation.

Why models might cite it

Original modeled state data, named primary inputs, a public formula, versioned updates, and observed GPL calibration create a source rather than a summary.

Dual risk

AI answers can reduce clicks on simple queries while increasing attribution for calculators, methodology questions, and state comparisons. Track both traffic and citations.

Ads set the floor; voluntary leads create the upside

Layer	Placement	Economics to test	Guardrail
Display ads	Below answer; between sections	Planning range: \$15-\$25 RPM	No takeover, auto-play, or dense ad load
Final-expense affiliate	State page and calculator result	Research range: \$20-\$60 CPL; \$100-\$300 CPS	Disclose; verify program and licenses
Prepaid-plan lead	Planning guides only, v2	Unknown until partner test	No personalized financial advice
GPL request tool	Local comparison flow, v2	Lead or sponsor model unproven	Do not sell rankings or imply endorsement

Illustrative 10,000-session month

Scenario	Ad assumption	Lead assumption	Gross monthly result
Conservative	\$15 RPM = \$150	$0.25\% \times \$20 = \500	\$650
Base	\$20 RPM = \$200	$0.50\% \times \$30 = \$1,500$	\$1,700
Optimistic	\$25 RPM = \$250	$1.00\% \times \$40 = \$4,000$	\$4,250

Illustrative model, not a forecast. "Lead assumption" is completed, accepted leads as a share of all sessions. Actual approval, payout, reversal, state eligibility, traffic mix, consent, and conversion may materially reduce results. Operating expenses and taxes are excluded.

Rollout order

- 1 Launch without monetization clutter.
- 2 Apply to AdSense after the site is complete and indexable; there is no guaranteed approval.
- 3 Test one affiliate only after terms, disclosures, and state eligibility are verified.
- 4 At scale, compare premium ad networks; use 50,000 sessions/month as a planning checkpoint and verify then-current eligibility.

Never monetize with

- Funeral-home paid rankings
- Fake scarcity or countdown timers
- Exit-intent quote popups
- Pre-checked consent boxes
- Personalized insurance advice
- Undisclosed referral fees
- Sale of calculator inputs

Policy: every monetized module is visually secondary to the answer and removable without making the page less useful.

Four weeks produce a measurable Phase 0

Week	Build stream	Exit criterion	Owner time
1	Domain, design system, source ingestion, model v1	Versioned data passes unit tests	60 min
2	Calculator, home, methodology, statistics	Printable result + provenance	45 min
3	Five state pages, guides, trust/legal pages	Every template passes content QA	60 min
4	SEO, analytics, accessibility, deployment, launch QA	Production crawl + event test clean	90 min
Buffer	Account approvals and fixes	No critical launch defect	45 min

Resource budget

\$0

INFRASTRUCTURE

Cloudflare Pages, public datasets, Search Console, Bing Webmaster, and basic analytics can start free.

~\$12

ANNUAL CASH

Domain estimate only. Confirm registrar price and renewal before purchase.

≤5h

OWNER SETUP

Decisions, accounts, domain purchase, compliance review, and launch sign-off.

Definition of done by workstream

Data and engineering

- ☐ Source files retain publication dates
- ☐ Formula tests cover all service types
- ☐ Every amount traces to a source or option
- ☐ Static export renders without JavaScript
- ☐ Calculator works keyboard-only
- ☐ Annual refresh script is documented

Content and trust

- ☐ Methodology names assumptions
- ☐ Statistics page uses consistent labels
- ☐ State pages name exclusions
- ☐ About/editorial/disclosure pages live
- ☐ No copied or generic filler prose

Search and measurement

- ☐ Canonical tags and sitemap validated
- ☐ Structured data matches visible content
- ☐ Search Console and Bing verified
- ☐ 30-keyword baseline recorded
- ☐ Affiliate events include page/placement IDs
- ☐ Monthly scorecard job produces one page

Operations

- ☐ Error alerts go to one inbox
- ☐ No database or manual publishing queue
- ☐ Dependency updates are monthly automated PRs
- ☐ Annual data review is the only planned refresh

Build boundary: this plan authorizes neither domain purchase nor implementation. Those remain owner decisions.

The calculator earns attention; the dataset earns links

Production launch checklist

- ☐ Purchase domain after final availability check
- ☐ Deploy Cloudflare Pages with HTTPS
- ☐ Verify canonical host and redirects
- ☐ Submit sitemap in Google Search Console
- ☐ Submit sitemap in Bing Webmaster Tools
- ☐ Test robots.txt, llms.txt, and structured data
- ☐ Confirm all five launch pages in static HTML
- ☐ Run performance and accessibility checks
- ☐ Record 30-keyword ranking baseline
- ☐ Test analytics and outbound click events
- ☐ Apply to AdSense only after content QA
- ☐ Apply to one verified affiliate program

Phase 0 linkable assets

- **Interactive estimator:** state-aware, printable, source-dated.
- **State cost map:** modeled relative costs with clear methodology.
- **Statistics page:** consistent, quotable national and state facts.
- **Methodology:** formula, versions, uncertainty, and GPL calibration.

First 30 days

- Publish one data note explaining the model.
- Send 10 personalized journalist pitches.
- Submit 10 relevant nonprofit/library resource suggestions.
- Contact 3 Funeral Consumers Alliance affiliates around the transparency mission.
- Answer only genuinely relevant community questions; no dropped-link spam.

Year-one backlink playbook

Motion	Asset	Cadence	Target
Digital PR	Annual State of Funeral Costs	1 report/year	Finance reporters
Local news	"X% vs national median" state angle	50 tailored pitches	Local outlets
Expert queries	Named data methodology	2 checks/week	Reporter requests
Resource pages	FTC rights guide + calculator	5 tailored notes/month	.org, .edu, libraries
Partnerships	Transparency-aligned materials	1 conversation/month	Consumer advocates

Connectively/HARO-style services change; use whichever legitimate reporter-query channels are operating at outreach time. Wikipedia-adjacent citation is appropriate only when the methodology is genuinely relevant and independent editors deem it useful.

Realistic year-one target

10-20

QUALITY REFERRING DOMAINS

Slow, relevant link velocity is healthier than hundreds of weak links.

Prohibited

No link buying, private blog networks, automated outreach spam, reciprocal schemes, fake expert profiles, or paid citations. One penalty can end a new YMYL-adjacent property.

Track visibility first; revenue is a month-six metric

North-star metric: 30-day average organic sessions per day and its percentage change versus the prior 30 days. It measures whether search distribution is compounding without requiring daily work.

Launch instrumentation

- **Google Search Console:** indexation, queries, pages, impressions, clicks, position.
- **Plausible or Umami:** privacy-friendly sessions and events; GA4 as backup.
- **Rank tracker:** 30 terms - 5 national and 25 state long-tails - checked weekly.
- **Core Web Vitals:** field data plus deployment-time lab checks.
- **Affiliate events:** UTM plus network sub-ID for page, service type, and CTA placement.
- **Ad dashboard:** page RPM, viewability, earnings, policy notices.

Supporting metrics

- **Search impressions/day:** earliest demand signal.
- **Tracked-set average position:** visibility movement; report median too so outliers do not mislead.
- **Affiliate CTR:** outbound quote clicks / eligible pageviews by page type.
- **Revenue:** ads + accepted lead commissions, separately.
- **Referring domains:** quality, relevance, and cumulative count.

Leading: indexed coverage, impressions growth, position movement, crawl frequency, referring domains. **Lagging:** sessions, accepted leads, RPM, revenue. Do not judge revenue before month 6.

Estimated 12-month trajectory

Mo.	Indexed	Impr./day	Sessions/day	Avg. pos.
1	12-20	0-20	0-2	80+
2	25-45	5-50	0-5	60-90
3	55-70	25-150	2-15	45-75
4	60-75	75-350	5-30	35-60
5	65-80	150-700	10-60	25-50
6	65-80	300-1,200	20-100	20-40
7	70-85	500-2,000	30-150	18-35
8	70-90	750-3,000	50-220	15-30
9	75-95	1,000-4,500	70-300	12-25
10	80-100	1,500-6,000	100-400	10-22
11	85-110	2,000-8,000	150-500	8-20
12	90-120	2,500-10,000	200-700	7-18

Mo.	Ref. domains	Gross revenue
1	0-1	\$0
2	0-2	\$0
3	1-3	\$0
4	2-4	\$0-\$25
5	3-6	\$0-\$60
6	4-8	\$10-\$150
7	5-9	\$20-\$250
8	6-11	\$40-\$400
9	7-13	\$75-\$650
10	8-15	\$120-\$1,000
11	9-18	\$180-\$1,500
12	10-20	\$250-\$2,500

Planning estimates, not promises. Assumptions: five-page MVP in month 1; all 50 state pages and core guides live by month 3; no manual action or algorithmic penalty; U.S.-weighted traffic; technically sound indexing; steady white-hat outreach; one approved affiliate by month 6. Average position refers only to the defined 30-keyword set.

Every review ends in fix, wait, continue, scale, or kill

Review	Numeric checks	Decision and action
Day 14 Technical	100% submitted URLs render 200; sitemap accepted; ≥80% launch URLs discovered; 0 blocking robots/canonical errors; CWV lab budget met.	Fix any blocker within 7 days. Otherwise wait; traffic is not judged.
Day 60 First signal	≥90% launch URLs indexed; 28-day impressions average ≥20/day and ≥25% above prior 28 days; ≥1 tracked query top 10 or ≥3 top 20.	Proceed to Phase 1 if trend plus ranking criterion passes. If flat, run diagnostics before expanding.
Day 120 Continue / kill	Continue: 30-day sessions average ≥10/day, ≥20% above prior 30 days; tracked average position improves ≥5 vs day 60 or ≥5 terms gain 10+ positions. Kill: 28-day impressions average <20/day and changes <10% for 60 days, after ≥90% indexation and diagnostics.	Scale lean if continue test passes. Hold one 30-day repair cycle if one metric narrowly misses. Kill when the full falsifiable kill test passes.
Day 180 Expansion	30-day average ≥150 organic sessions/day; ≥5 tracked state terms top 10; ≥10 quality referring domains.	Add top-50 metros and GPL calibration only if at least 2 of 3 pass and trend is rising.
Day 365 Scale	500+ organic sessions/day or 50,000 sessions/month; positive 90-day trend; ≥10 accepted leads/month or ad RPM ≥\$15.	Test second affiliate and premium ads; verify current network eligibility before applying.

Ordered miss-diagnostic - do not skip steps

- 1 Technical:** check indexation coverage, sitemap, canonicals, robots, noindex, rendered HTML, schema errors, mobile CWV, status codes. Fix and allow 14-30 days for recrawl.
- 2 Content:** compare search queries with page intent; test whether state pages are thin, repetitive, or omit inclusions, local rights, or direct answers. Upgrade the weakest five pages first.
- 3 Competition:** inspect the current top 10 for every tracked miss. Record new entrants, link gaps, information gain, and SERP features. Do not “add words”; add missing utility.
- 4 Demand:** compare actual impressions with the keyword thesis. If technically healthy, content-complete pages cannot generate impressions across the set, the demand estimate was wrong.

Monthly 15-minute scorecard

Auto-generate one page with: indexed/total URLs; impressions/day and 30-day change; organic sessions/day and change; tracked average and median position; count in top 3/10/20; quality referring domains; affiliate eligible views, clicks, CTR, accepted leads and EPC; ad RPM and revenue; total revenue; CWV pass/fail; open technical errors; next decision date.

Cadence

Weekly automated: rank snapshot, crawl error alert, uptime, affiliate event sanity check.

Monthly human: 15-minute scorecard review and one chosen action.

Stage gates: 30 minutes at days 60, 120, 180, and 365.

Interpretation: months 1-4 are judged on visibility. Revenue before month 6 is anecdotal and cannot rescue weak search signals or condemn a healthy ranking trajectory.

A narrow approval unlocks the next four weeks

Risk register

Risk	Early warning	Mitigation	Residual
YMYL-adjacent trust climb	Indexed, but positions stall	Method, sources, editorial policy, original data	High
AI answer cannibalization	Impressions rise; CTR falls	Calculator, printable output, citation pages	Medium
Modeled-data criticism	Source disputes or corrections	Clear labels, versioning, GPL calibration	Medium
Tastefulness backlash	Low engagement; complaints	Secondary CTAs, no dark patterns, calm copy	Low
Affiliate rejection	No approved partner	Ads floor; keep content partner-neutral	Medium
Search dependency	Broad ranking loss	Links, press citations, Bing/AI visibility	High

Owner approvals required

- 1

Domain: approve purchase of funeralcostinfo.com after a fresh availability and renewal-price check. It was reported available on 23 September 2026; availability is not reserved.
- 2

Scope: approve five states + home + calculator + methodology + statistics + trust pages.
- 3

Monetization: confirm disclosed final-expense affiliate participation is acceptable.
- 4

Validation: approve the explicit 120-day exception to the normal 14-day kill cycle.

Assumptions made

- U.S.-only, English-language launch
- Consumer-side positioning; no funeral-home revenue
- Muse performs most build and research work
- Owner time cap: five hours before external signal
- Static hosting and no user accounts
- Revenue figures are gross planning ranges
- No legal, insurance, or financial advice

Go order: approve the four decisions, purchase the domain, then start Week 1. Everything beyond Phase 0 remains gated by the Day 60 review.

Primary sources

1. NFDA, 2023 General Price List Study release

2. BEA, Regional Price Parities

3. FTC, Calling for Information About Funeral Pricing

4. BLS, CPI 12-month analysis table
5. Parting overview and cited company history

6. Funeralocity revenue-model profile

7. Foundation Partners acquisition of Cake

8. Precoa acquisition of Everplans

Source access checked 23 September 2026. Market-rate ranges for CPC, affiliate payouts, lead prices, ad RPM, and domain cost are planning inputs from the commissioned research; all must be re-verified before a contract, purchase, or forecast.